> Russia is a country with a history that spans more than a thousand years and has practically always used the privilege to carry out an independent foreign policy. We are not going to change this tradition today. At the same time, we are well aware of how the world has changed, and we have a realistic sense of our opportunities and potential. And of course, we would like to interact with responsible and independent partners with whom we could work together in constructing a fair and democratic world order, which would ensure security and prosperity not only for a select few but for all. (Putin 2007)[12]

Furthermore, the US aggression toward the Russian strategic region, and its active involvement in the CIS region, caused severe damage to Russia and Western relations. Russia had to become more aggressive, considering the conditions that prevailed. In this context, the State Duma Foreign Affairs Committee Chairman Konstantin Kosachev said that the new foreign policy concept should consider Russia's unique role as a richer and more assertive power (Haas 2010). In this context, Russia started allocating more grants to its Defense Budget and investing excessively in military apparatus production. Gradually, Russia built its military potential, competed in the global arms trade, and started challenging the US military-technical areas. Due to this economic diversity, Russia's economic growth and stature in international arms trade eventually increased. The forced circumstances around Russia's territory also had Russia increase its defense budget rapidly (Tables 3.2 and 3.3).

Table 3.2 Russia's total exports and share of arms exports

	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010
Russia’s total exports in billion USD	243.6	303.9	354.4	471.6	334	400.4
Share of arms export in percentile	2.52	2.13	2.13	1.77	2.96	2.59

Source Russian Federal State Statistics Service, CAST Calculations

Table 3.3 Russian defense budget, billion USD in current prices

	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010
Total	19.9	26.4	33.8	39.9	38.9	44.7
Ministry of the Interior	6.6	8.9	11.3	13.3	13.0	14.6